GATEWAY BUILDING · ZERO WASTE ORIENTATION

UC Berkeley Zero Waste

Gateway Zero Waste

First in the World.

Welcome! Grab a seat and explore the Gateway Dashboard while you wait.

TUESDAY, OCT 6, 2026 · 10:30 AM – 12 PM · ROOM 1420

FREE REUSABLE UTENSIL KIT · FIRST 50 ATTENDEES

SCAN WHILE YOU WAIT

Explore the Gateway Dashboard

UC Berkeley
Zero Waste

Gateway is the first building in the world to pursue TRUE Zero Waste certification for both construction and operations.



Berkeley is a global leader in innovation. Let's keep it that way.

SECTION 01

TRUE ZERO WASTE

What we're pursuing, and what we've already won

What the certification means, why it matters, and the results Gateway earned before move-in.



But what is *TRUE, really?*

TRUE (Total Resource Use and Efficiency) is an international certification for how well a building manages its waste: reusing, sorting, composting, and recycling so as little as possible ends up in landfill or incineration.

Think of it like LEED, but for materials.

90%+ of waste kept out of landfill and incineration

7 minimum requirements every project must meet

31 of 81 points needed to certify, earned across credit categories

CREDIT CATEGORIES INCLUDE

- Waste Diversion
- Reuse
- Composting
- Zero waste purchasing
- Hazardous waste prevention
- Occupant training
- Leadership

Global, growing, *and it pays off.*

GLOBAL & GROWING

500+ projects certified worldwide

8.9M tons of waste kept out of landfills

7M+ MT of greenhouse gas emissions prevented

IT PAYS OFF

~$20K saved per year on waste costs, on average

~$22K earned per year selling recyclables

Less waste to landfill means lower hauling fees, and clean recyclables are worth money.

Source: USGBC, The Zero Waste Blueprint (2025), a study of TRUE-certified projects.

Why it matters *beyond Gateway.*

UC SYSTEMWIDE

90%

of municipal solid waste diverted from landfill, at every campus

UC SYSTEMWIDE

–50%

waste per person vs. FY 2015–16, by 2030 (–25% by 2025)

UC BERKELEY

2030

eliminate non-essential single-use plastic, which Berkeley calls the country's strongest ban

THE SCIENCE · WHY PLASTIC

Over a quarter of UC Berkeley's waste is non-recyclable plastic.

Diverting isn't enough. UC also asks us to make less waste.

Sources: UC Sustainable Practices Policy (Zero Waste); UC Berkeley Single-Use Plastic Elimination Target (2020).

Our TRUE impact. *Before the doors opened.*



TRUE

UC BERKELEY GATEWAY CONSTRUCTION

Berkeley, California

HAS FULFILLED THE CERTIFICATION REQUIREMENTS OF THE FOLLOWING LEVEL OF TRUE, AS VERIFIED BY GREEN BUSINESS CERTIFICATION INC. TRUE IS A ZERO WASTE CERTIFICATION PROGRAM. THE UC BERKELEY GATEWAY CONSTRUCTION HAS ACHIEVED A WASTE DIVERSION RATE OF 99% FOR THE MOST RECENT 12 MONTHS AT THE TIME OF CERTIFICATION.

PLATINUM

August 2026

Peter Templeton
President & CEO, Green Business Certification Inc.

Platinum

HIGHEST TRUE LEVEL · 63 POINTS

99.01% of construction waste diverted: 66,751 tons kept out of landfill

~$1.8M saved by sorting materials at the source

FIRST PUBLIC PROJECT WITH TRUE PLATINUM FOR CONSTRUCTION

Waste we *never made.*



01 Sort at the source

One bin per material: metal, concrete, wood, drywall, soil, cardboard. Lower disposal costs plus rebates: about $1.8M saved.



02 Reusable shipping crates

Trades swapped single-use wood crating for reusable metal bunks and containers, saving 100+ tons of lumber.



03 Trees into tables

Trees cut down on site became tables now used across campus.

THE SCIENCE

Crating is usually burned, and burning wood emits more CO_2e per BTU than diesel, gasoline, or coal.

SECTION 02

OUR SYSTEMS

How we reach 90% diversion in operations

The four systems behind the scenes, and how you can use what we've built.



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Three streams. *One habit.*

GREEN BIN

Compost / 01

Food scraps & peels
Coffee grounds & filters
Napkins & soiled paper
Approved compostable serviceware
Tea bags & plant trimmings

BLUE BIN

Recycle / 02

Bottles & aluminum cans
Rigid plastics #1 & #2
Glass containers
Empty & rinsed, please

Clean paper & cardboard

BLACK BIN

Landfill / 03

Last resort only
Foil-lined wrappers
Soft, mixed plastics
Coated paper cups
Not sure? Ask.

NOT EVERYTHING THAT SOUNDS GREEN IS.

Plant-based, biodegradable, and bioplastic products aren't always compostable. More on that in a second.

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Know your plastics. *Look for the number.*

NUMBER	COMMON ITEMS	GATEWAY
1	**Bottles & clear containers** Water bottles, soda bottles, clear food containers	Recycle
2	**Milk, detergent & shampoo bottles** Milk jugs, detergent bottles, shampoo & body wash bottles	Recycle
3-7	**Most other plastics** Plastic film, chip bags, yogurt cups, takeout lids, utensils, mixed plastics	Landfill

Not sure?
Use the black landfill bin.

Contamination causes entire bags of recycling or compost to be discarded.

#1 & #2
→ *Recycle*

#3 – 7
→ *Landfill*

Soft plastics & film
→ *Landfill*

Check the bottom of the package. Still not sure? Landfill bin, then ask us.

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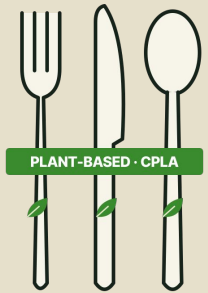
Looks compostable. *Goes to landfill.*



→ LANDFILL BIN

“Compostable” cups

PLA plastic, labeled #7



→ LANDFILL BIN

“Plant-based” cutlery

CPLA plastic

Many departments are buying these right now.

THE SCIENCE · PLA

PLA is made from plants, but it only breaks down in high-heat industrial composting (around 58°C / 136°F). Gateway's compost stream doesn't accept it, and because it looks like plastic, it contaminates the bin.

→ WHAT YOU CAN DO

Need single-use? Buy the real thing.

The Approved Products Catalog lists items that truly compost here: paper- and fiber-based. Reusables still come first.

Four systems. *One 90% goal.*

01

Building Systems

Tracking every material that enters and leaves the building.

02

Reuse Systems

Reusables in the café, kitchens, events, and ReUse Stations.

03

Circular Purchasing

Buying things that stay in use, not in the bin.

04

Recovery Systems

Compost, e-waste, and food rescue for what's left.

HOW TO READ THE NEXT SLIDES

→ WHAT YOU CAN DO

Things you'll use or do every day

★ CURRENT WINS

Work already happening behind the scenes

◆ THE SCIENCE

The data and engineering behind it

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What goes in *must come out.*

IN

- Purchases & deliveries
- Packaging & pallets
- Food & café



OUT · TRACKED BY WEIGHT

- **Reuse** ReUse Stations, Dispatch, reusables
- **Recycling** Bottles, cans, paper, baled cardboard
- **Compost** Food scraps, the Mill
- **Specialty recovery** E-waste and batteries
- **Food rescue** Café surplus to Basic Needs
- **Landfill** The part we work to shrink

THE SCIENCE · MASS BALANCE

`Diversion rate = (reuse + recycling + compost + recovery) ÷ everything discarded`

TRUE requires 90% or more, measured by weight over 12 months.

Building systems. *The big moves.*

★ CURRENT WINS · BEHIND THE SCENES

- Separate hauling for landfill, recycling, and compost, each tracked by weight
- Cardboard balers compact cardboard for recycling
- Pallets logged in and out for reuse and recycling

IN PROGRESS · ENERGY & WATER DATA TRACKING



→ WHAT YOU CAN DO

Why no desk-side bins?

Shared waste stations help people sort and keep offices free of odors and pests. After Facilities Services budget cuts, desk-side pickup is no longer part of standard service.

Reuse systems. *Built into your day.*



The café *Dispatch Goods*

Borrow a container, finish your meal, drop it in an orange Dispatch bin. No rinsing needed.



Social kitchens *Reuse first*

Reusable plates, cups, and utensils are the default. Scrape food into compost, load the dishwasher.



Events *In progress*

Reusable eventware is on the way. Until then, follow the catering and event guidelines.

★ CURRENT WINS · BEHIND THE SCENES

- The café runs on Dispatch Goods reusables
- Kitchen reusables avoid an estimated 425,500 disposable items a year

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ReUse Stations. *Take what you need.*



REFILL HUB

→ *Circular purchasing*

SHARED STOCK

→ *Reuse*

BATTERIES

→ *Recovery*

Refill Hub

120 Pilot B2P starter pens plus 120 G2 refills. Each refill replaces a new pen: 120 × 9 g ≈ 1.1 kg of plastic saved a year.

Shared Stock

Usable office supplies: binders, folders, organizers, paper clips. Take some, leave extras.

Battery recycling

Drop off used batteries on the bottom shelf.

...and leave what you can. 4th floor station coming soon!

Circular purchasing. *Your biggest lever.*

Circular purchasing means buying things that stay in use: reusable, refillable, recycled-content, or minimally packaged, so they never become waste in the first place.

> *"What you buy decides what shows up in our waste numbers."*

GATEWAY PURCHASING HIERARCHY · WORK TOP DOWN



Buy it better. *We've made it easy.*

→ WHAT YOU CAN DO

Approved Products Catalog

EPP versions of what you already buy, plus truly compostable single-use items.

Approved caterers

Book from the approved caterer list: bulk trays, reusable serviceware, no single-use plastic.

Reuse before you buy

Check a ReUse Station for supplies before placing any order.

★ CURRENT WINS · BEHIND THE SCENES

- Custodial product review: switching to concentrates cuts packaging waste and cost
- Procurement partnership: bulk EPP products from Blaisdell's, sold at a discount through Stanley Stockroom (in progress)

Recovery systems. *Nothing useful wasted.*

→ WHAT YOU CAN DO

- Compost food scraps in the Mill food recycler (1st floor social kitchen)
- Recycle e-waste instead of trashing it
- Drop batteries at a ReUse Station's bottom shelf



★ CURRENT WINS · BEHIND THE SCENES

- Excess café food is donated to the Basic Needs Center
- Mill output started a vermicomposting initiative
- Push toward greener landscaping
- Waste audits show us where to improve next: SCAN HERE

THE SCIENCE · METHANE

Food in landfill rots without oxygen and releases methane, roughly 28× as potent as CO_2 over 100 years.

SECTION 03

YOUR ROLE

Where you come in

What we need from you, the resources we've built to make it easy, and how to get involved.



What we need *from you.*

01

Sort it right

Three bins, one habit. Take an extra second before you toss.

02

Reuse & refill first

Check a ReUse Station or the catalog before you buy anything new.

03

Engage & speak up

Use our resources and programs, and tell us what isn't working.



Together, we can pave the way for other buildings to follow.

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Everything *in one place.*

Gateway Dashboard

Scan to follow along. Live walkthrough next.

Gateway Dashboard

Every system from today, in one interactive site.



Zero Waste Operations Manual

Sorting, purchasing, kitchens, catering, events, and the café.

Approved Products Catalog

Environmentally preferred versions of what you already buy.

RESOURCE LIBRARY

The manual, the Approved Products Catalog, this slide deck, and more on our TRUE construction certification. All on the dashboard.

Want to get *more involved?*

Quick survey

Questions, comments, concerns, and Green Team interest.

GREEN TEAM · NO COMMITMENT TODAY

Curious about being your team's Green Team Representative?

- Be the link between your team and Building Operations
- Help keep signage and QR resources current
- Share updates and feedback with the Zero Waste team

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You're not just moving into a new building.

You're joining something bigger.



QUESTIONS FOR YOU

- What's the hardest thing to sort in your day?
- What does your team buy most that could be reusable?
- What would make a ReUse Station useful to you?

Welcome to Gateway. Let's make it count.